

Ashton Howard

FULL STACK SOFTWARE ENGINEER

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Web Developer and Software Engineer fueled by curiosity and a passion for growth. Views every line of code as a chance to innovate and refine skills. Thrives on tackling complex problems and finds excitement in unraveling tough challenges to craft effective solutions. Eager to explore new technologies and stay ahead in the fast-paced tech world. Ready to collaborate and code toward building a dynamic future.

Experienced in a wide range of skills including:

LANGUAGES: JavaScript, Python, Typescript, SQL, HTML5, CSS

FRAMEWORKS & LIBRARIES: React, Redux, Next.js, Flask, Express, Sequelize, NextAuth, Tailwind, Framer Motion, TinaCMS, Nodemailer

DATABASES: SQLite3, SQLAlchemy, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, AWS S3, Cloudinary

TOOLS: Git, AWS, Linux, GraphQL, Docker, Postman, Figma, Visual Studio Code

OTHER: UI/UX principles, Pair Programming, Test-Driven Development (TDD), Object-Oriented Programming (OOP), RESTful APIs (Representational State Transfer APIs), Communication, Team Collaboration, Problem Solving, Time Management

WORK EXPERIENCE

Recro >> *Solutions Engineer* > *Fairfax, VA*

November 2025 – Present

Qrypt – Full-Stack Quantum Encryption Platform >> Next.js, React, TypeScript, Rust, Figma, AWS

- Architected and developed a quantum encryption management platform, enabling enterprise customers to monitor telemetry and insights across AWS, cloud providers, and air-gapped environments.
- Directed client-focused full-stack development, managing web applications end-to-end from requirements gathering to deployment and ongoing maintenance.

Recro >> *Software Engineer Intern* > *Fairfax, VA*

February 2025 – October 2025

Recro.com >> ReactJS, Next.js, TinaCMS, NextAuth, Tailwind, MongoDB, Framer Motion, AWS (EC2, S3)

[Github](#) > [Live](#)

- Engineered a parallax-scrolling web interface with Framer Motion animations, improving user engagement metrics by 40% through smooth, responsive visual effects across devices.
- Integrated TinaCMS, a React-based headless CMS, empowering all authorized users to edit and publish content without developer involvement, cutting update time by 70%.
- Built a Google OAuth 2.0 authentication system using NextAuth.js, incorporating custom token refresh logic to maintain secure, uninterrupted sessions for all CMS users and improve authentication reliability by 95%.
- Self-hosted a MongoDB database on AWS EC2, configuring TLS/SSL certificates to encrypt data in transit and ensure secure storage for CMS and authentication data.

Recro's Partner Portal >> ReactJS, Next.js, TinaCMS, NextAuth, Tailwind, Framer Motion, MongoDB, AWS (EC2, S3)

[GitHub](#) > [Live](#)

- Devised a secure integration linking the company's partner portal with HubSpot CRM, delivering real-time visibility into all active deals through an API optimized for 60% faster data retrieval.
- Implemented a HubSpot-integrated deal submission API, streamlining user deal creation by automating CRM ticket generation and reducing manual data entry by 80%.
- Orchestrated a React deal/ticket card component displaying real-time HubSpot status and progress, instantly syncing CRM updates to the partner portal.
- Engineered a dynamic partner portal dashboard providing a personalized experience by highlighting content based on each user's preferences and activity.

Freelance >> *Software Engineer* > Fairfax, VA

December 2023 – January 2025

Popcorn-Palette >> ReactJS, Redux, SQLAlchemy, Flask, Docker, CSS

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- Developed an interactive feature enabling users to add movies to their watchlist directly from the homepage. Used useState to toggle between a "+" icon and a checkmark, and useSelector to track the movie's watchlist status. Ensured real-time UI updates for instant feedback, optimizing performance with smooth interactions and efficient state synchronization.
- Utilized CSS translate & transform to animate placeholder values, on mouse hover, for collections with less than 5 movies and z-index to keep the order correct, creating a polished and dynamic user experience.
- Built a dynamic dropdown that shows real-time movie search results as users type, fetching data from an external API. Used useState, useRef, and useEffect to manage input, dropdown visibility, and trigger API calls. Users are redirected to the movie's details page upon selection for seamless navigation.
- Designed a feature that retrieves a movie's cast from a third-party API when viewing a specific film. Used useState to manage cast display and useSelector to access movie data from Redux. Made GET requests to The Movie Database API, enabling smooth navigation through cast members with arrow controls and real-time UI updates.

KANA >> ReactJS, Redux, SQLAlchemy, Flask, Docker, CSS

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- Crafted an interactive avatar feature allowing users to customize avatars with parts like heads, eyes, and backgrounds. Used useState for real-time updates and Redux for data management, dynamically fetching parts from a database. Users can save, update, or delete avatars, with a modal interface and random generation option to enhance the experience.
- Conceived a React component that enables users to open a menu for adding tasks, which then triggers modals for task creation. Leveraged useState to manage menu visibility and useRef to track the menu element, while event listeners added through useEffect ensure the menu closes when users click outside, providing a seamless user interaction.
- Implemented universal CSS variables and classes to streamline styling across the site, facilitating easier maintenance and updates.
- Engineered an interactive rewards system where users can purchase and manage items from a randomized table, boosting engagement. Used useState for feedback, useDispatch to update Redux, and useModal for real-time updates and smooth interactions when rewards are bought or deleted.

Norseman Defense Services >> *System Administrator Intern* > Elkridge, MD

August 2020 – August 2021

Enterprise Device Management Deployment

- Deployed Mobile Device Management software across all work-related devices for new employees, ensuring comprehensive management and seamless accessibility of all devices when needed. This initiative streamlined operations and enhanced device security within the organization.
- Revitalized acquired devices by thoroughly wiping their hard drives, preparing them for reuse by new employees. This process ensured data security and optimized resources, facilitating a smooth onboarding experience.

EDUCATION

APP ACADEMY >> Full Stack Web Development

Completed November 2024